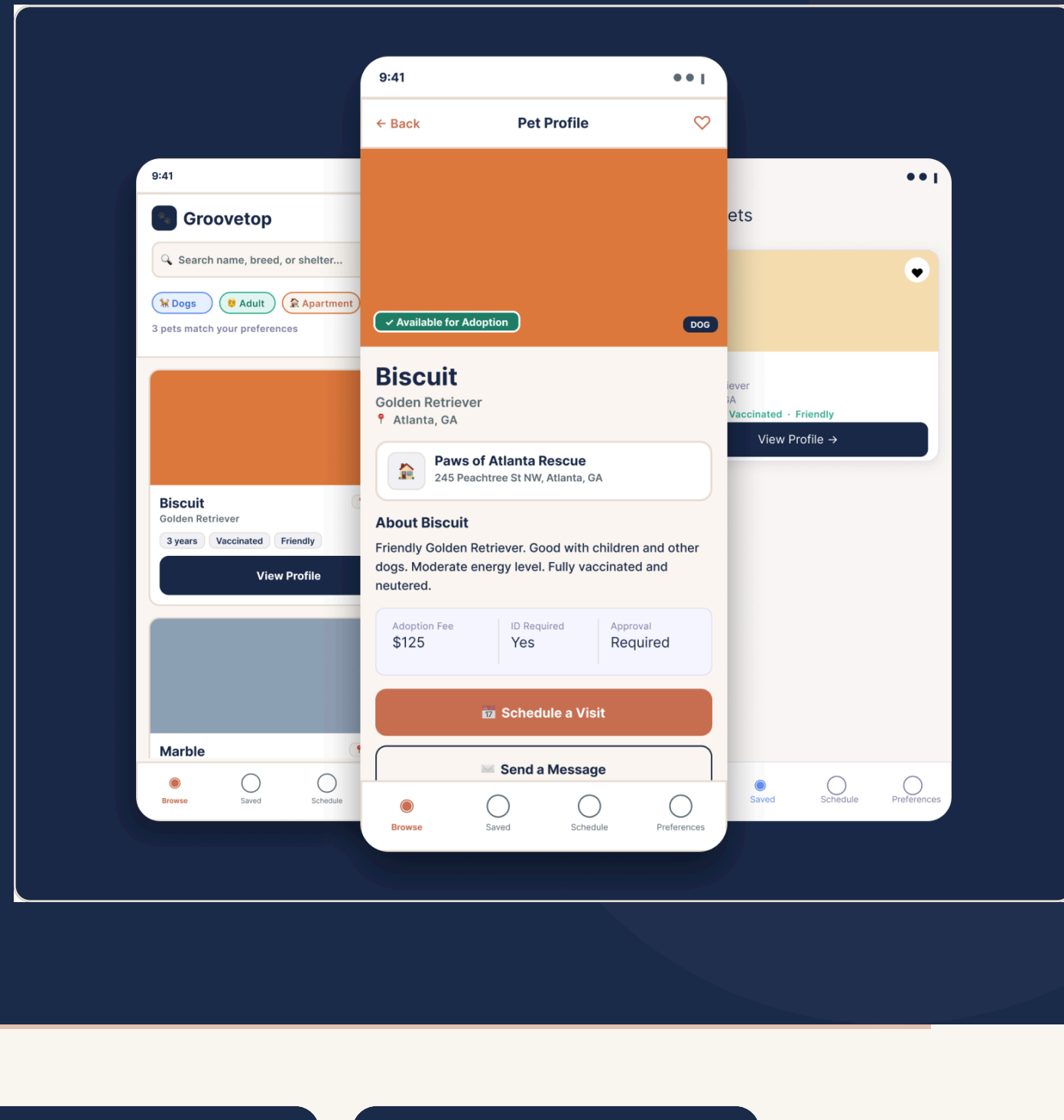


Groovetop Dog App

An award-winning WGU UX prototype refined into a documented design system and scalable mobile app concept.

WGU Excellence Award · Prototyping and Iterating II, Task 2 · May 2026

Certificate signed by Kirk A. Welter, Vice President, Evaluation Operations.



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Project Overview

Groovetop was a WGU UX Design mobile app assignment to design a dog adoption experience for iOS. The project received a WGU Excellence Award in May 2026 for exemplary work in Prototyping and Iterating II, Task 2.

After the award, I extracted and documented the prototype's visual direction into Groovetop DS v1 — a design system with semantic color tokens, 10 typography styles, five reusable component sets with editable properties, and 452 token bindings applied back to all six original screens.

68

Design Tokens

10

Text Styles

5

Component Sets

23

Variants

452

Token Bindings

PROJECT CONTEXT

Academic → Portfolio

Academic Setting

WGU UX Design - Individual assignment

Assignment

Prototyping and Iterating II, Task 2

Outcome

WGU Excellence Award · May 2026

Post-Award

Refined into Groovetop DS v1

Scope Note

Academic project · Not a live client product

No Metrics

No real-world adoption data claimed

PROBLEM STATEMENT

The Problem

Pet adoption browsing can feel fragmented and emotionally overloaded — too many options with no clear path to action. The app needed a warm, mobile-first experience: browse dogs, compare, save favorites, view full details, and schedule a visit without friction.



Fragmented Experience

Adoption browsing lacks a calm, structured mobile flow that guides users from discovery to decision.



No Clear Path to Action

Users need a direct route from browsing → saving → scheduling → confirmation without friction.

TARGET USERS

Who This Is For

First-Time Adopter

Needs clear guidance from browse to decision

Returning Pet Owner

Wants efficient filtering and comparison

Multi-Pet Shopper

Comparing multiple dogs before choosing

Decision-Ready User

Needs a simple browse → schedule → confirm flow

PRODUCT GOAL

Goal

Design a warm, simple mobile experience for dog adoption. Give users a clear path from browsing through scheduling — with enough information at each step to make a confident decision.

MY ROLE

Role

- UX Designer
- Visual Designer
- Prototype Designer
- Design System Creator (post-award)
- Individual Academic Project

DESIGN CONSTRAINTS

Constraints

Academic assignment scope

Mobile-first prototype (390×844px)

Six-screen story arc

No live backend or real data

No real adoption metrics

Claim-safe portfolio framing

ORIGINAL ASSIGNMENT SCOPE

Six Screens

01 Browse Pets

02 Pet Profile

03 Schedule Visit

04 Confirmation

05 Preferences

06 Saved Pets

Each screen supported a focused moment in the adoption decision flow.

UX PROCESS

Design Process

01 Problem Framing

02 User Flow Planning

03 Screen Architecture

04 Visual Direction

05 Prototype Refinement

06 Award Outcome

WGU Excellence Award

07 Design System Extraction

08 System Application

INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

App Structure

Browse

Saved Pets

Preferences

Pet Profile

Schedule Visit

Confirmation

Primary flows: Browse → Pet Profile → Schedule Visit → Confirmation · Browse → Save Pet → Saved Pets · Preferences → Adjust criteria → Return to Browse

CORE USER FLOWS

Three Primary Flows

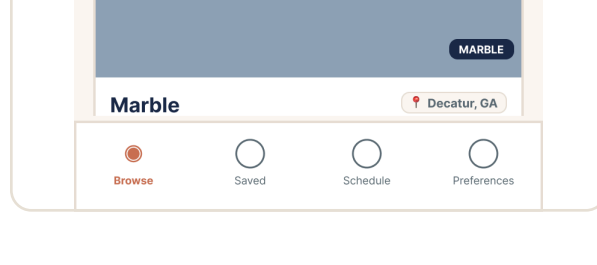
Flow 1: Browse → Pet Profile → Schedule Visit → Confirmation

Flow 2: Browse → Save Pet → Saved Pets → Continue Deciding

Flow 3: Preferences → Adjust Filters → Return to Browse

SCREEN-BY-SCREEN BREAKDOWN

Six Screens Analyzed

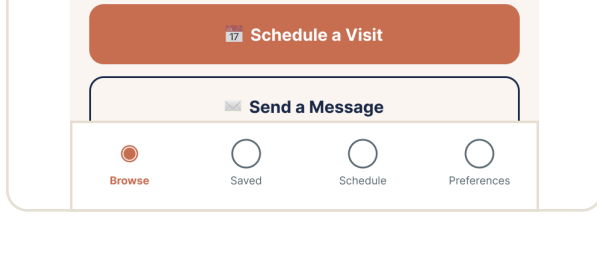


01 Browse Pets

PURPOSE
Primary entry point. Presents available dogs as browsable cards with status badges and a search bar at the top.

KEY UX DECISION
Card-first layout with filter chips allows quick scanning. Visual identity established here carries through the entire flow.

DESIGN SYSTEM NOTE
Pet Card, Badge, and Search Bar components active. Bottom Nav shows Browse as the active state.

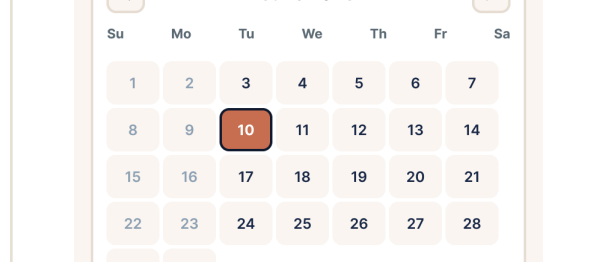


02 Pet Profile

PURPOSE
Full detail view for a selected dog — photo, name, breed, age, description, status badge, and adoption CTAs.

KEY UX DECISION
Visual hierarchy flows from photo → identity → supporting details → primary action. CTA stays visible without scrolling.

DESIGN SYSTEM NOTE
Badge (Species, Status), Button (Primary and Ghost styles), radius/xi on photo container.

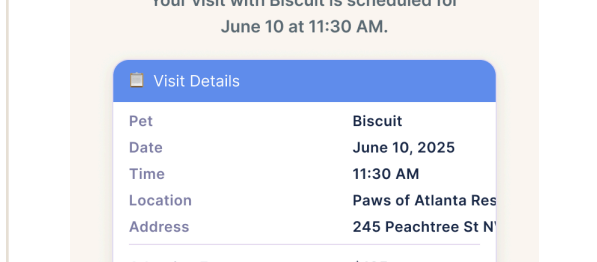


03 Schedule Visit

PURPOSE
Calendar and time slot selector for booking an in-person adoption visit.

KEY UX DECISION
Available and unavailable time slots are visually differentiated using status color tokens — no ambiguity in the booking state.

DESIGN SYSTEM NOTE
color/status/success-bg (available) and terracotta tones (unavailable) applied directly from semantic tokens.

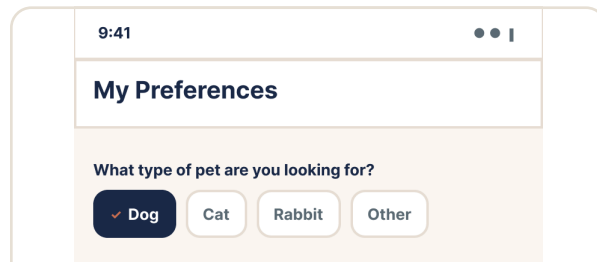


04 Confirmation

PURPOSE
Post-scheduling confirmation screen. Reassures the user the visit is booked and provides next-step options.

KEY UX DECISION
Positive visual treatment — terracotta confirmation mark, warm copy, and clear next-action buttons reduce post-booking anxiety.

DESIGN SYSTEM NOTE
color/brand/status/primary drives the confirmation icon. Button component used for both next-step actions.

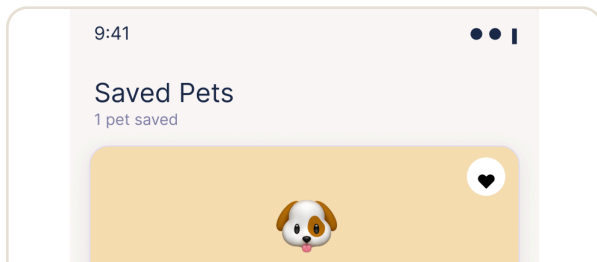


05 Preferences

PURPOSE
Adoption preferences setup — dog size, age, temperament, and living situation filters.

KEY UX DECISION
Chip-based multi-select is a familiar mobile pattern. Minimal visual hierarchy keeps focus on quick, low-effort selection.

DESIGN SYSTEM NOTE
Interactive background tokens applied to chip selections. Grid layout aligns with the overall spacing system.



06 Saved Pets

PURPOSE
Saved dog list — lets users return to bookmarked pets and continue their decision at any time.

KEY UX DECISION
Saved is always one tap away via Bottom Nav. Returning to this screen keeps the browsing loop low-friction.

DESIGN SYSTEM NOTE
Pet Card Saved variant used throughout. Bottom Nav highlights Saved as the active state.

VISUAL DESIGN DIRECTION

Nordic Warm

The Nordic Warm direction uses deep navy for trust and structure, terracotta for warmth and primary calls to action, and oat cream for calm background surfaces. Clean white cards and rounded corners create a friendly but organized adoption experience.

Deep Navy

#1B2A4A

Trust · Structure · Text

Terracotta

#C85133

Warmth · CTAs · Accents

Oat Cream

#FAF7F1

Soft BG · Calm Surfaces

White

#FFFFFF

Cards · Clean Surfaces

Success Green

#2EAB8C

Available · Positive State

Blue

#4682B4

Interactive · Links

DESIGN SYSTEM EXTRACTION

Groovetop DS v1

Groovetop DS v1 was created after the Excellence Award to systematize the existing visual direction — not replace it. Extracted directly from the prototype screens and structured into reusable tokens, styles, and components without introducing new visual language.

4

Variable Collections

68

Design Tokens

10

Text Styles

5

Component Sets

23

Variants

9

Component Properties

25

Active Semantic Tokens (of 28 in the color collection)

6

Token-Connected Screens

COMPONENT SYSTEM

Five Component Families

Button, Pet Card, Badge, Search Bar, and Bottom Nav were built as real Figma component sets with variant axes and editable component properties. Source sets are preserved in the DS v1 file and available from the Assets panel for direct reuse.

Button

VARIANTS

Style=Primary|Secondary|Ghost

Size=Large|Medium|Small

PROPS

Label TEXT · Show icon BOOLEAN

Primary CTAs: Adopt, Schedule, Contact

Pet Card

VARIANTS

Variant=Browse|Saved

PROPS

Pet Name · Breed/Meta · CTA Label

Dog listing cards in Browse · Saved

Badge

VARIANTS

Type=Available|Unavailable|Species|Status

PROPS

Label TEXT

Availability, vaccination, species tags

Search Bar

VARIANTS

State=Default|Active|Filtered

PROPS

Placeholder Text

Pet search on Browse screen

Bottom Nav

VARIANTS

Active=Browse|Saved|Schedule|Match|Preferences

PROPS

Persistent app navigation

APPLYING THE SYSTEM BACK TO SCREENS

Token Connection

452 color token bindings and 63 text style applications were applied across all six original screens. 25 of 28 semantic color tokens are actively referenced. Screen dimensions (390×844px) and visual identity were preserved throughout. Component replacement was not forced where doing so would compromise existing layout fidelity.

452

Color Bindings

fills + strokes across 6 screens

63

Text Style Apps

applied text styles across 6 screens

25

Active Tokens

of 28 semantic tokens referenced

0

Broken Bindings

zero regression — all bindings intact

ACCESSIBILITY + USABILITY

Design Considerations

- Clear visual hierarchy — primary action always prominent and above the fold
- Large mobile tap targets on all primary CTAs
- Strong contrast between primary action surfaces and backgrounds
- Simple, linear flow: browse → profile → schedule → confirmation
- Persistent Bottom Nav keeps core destinations always one tap away
- Status badges communicate availability / Unavailable states with color and label
- Future: formal WCAG 2.1 AA contrast audit · screen-reader annotations · focus and disabled states

OUTCOME: WGU EXCELLENCE AWARD

Recognition

This WGU UX Design mobile app assignment received a WGU Excellence Award in May 2026 for exemplary work in Prototyping and Iterating II, Task 2. The certificate was signed by Kirk A. Welter, Vice President, Evaluation Operations.

PRESENTED TO

Raymond Merrill II

DATE

May 2026

COURSE

Prototyping and Iterating II

TASK

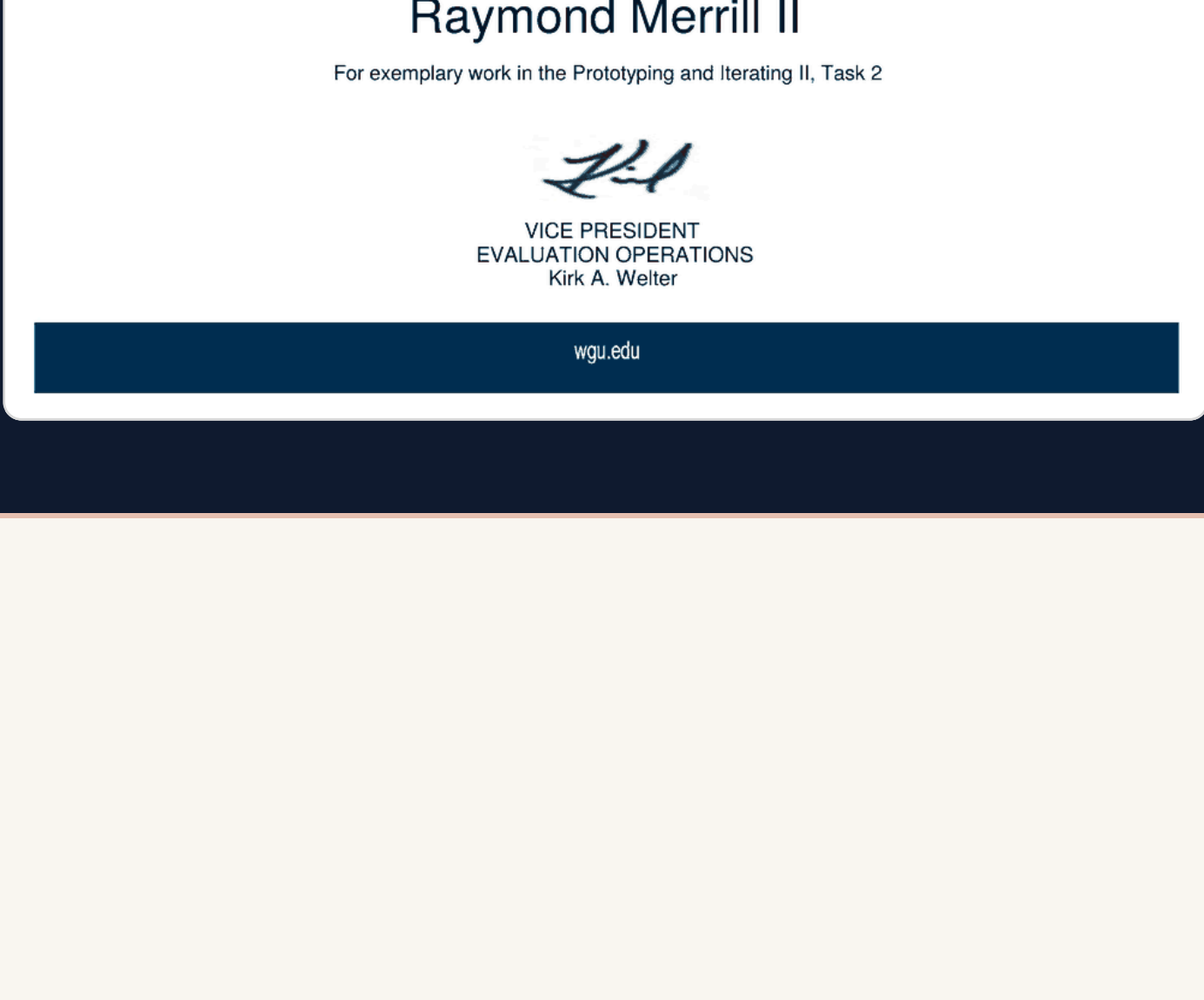
Task 2

AWARD

Excellence Award

SIGNATURE

Kirk A. Welter, Vice President, Evaluation Operations



WHAT I BUILT AFTER THE AWARD

Post-Award Refinement

- Built Groovetop DS v1 — extracted directly from the actual prototype screens
- Structured 68 semantic design tokens across 4 collections: Primitives, Color, Spacing, Radius
- Created 10 inter-text styles covering Display through Caption
- Built 5 real Figma component sets with 23 variants
- Wired 9 editable component properties (Label, Placeholder Text, Pet Name, and more)
- Applied 452 token bindings back to all 6 original screens

WHAT I WOULD IMPROVE NEXT

Future Improvements

Typography

Expand the type scale for uncovered small and display sizes.

Tokens

Add a dark surface token for navy frame fills.

Components

Refactor screens for deeper component-instance usage.

Accessibility

Add WCAG audit, screen-reader notes, and focus specs.

Interaction

Define hover, pressed, and disabled states.

Prototype

Polish transitions for recruiter demos.

Export

Export final recruiter-ready PDF.

Portfolio

Build public portfolio webpage.

PORTFOLIO SUMMARY · RECRUITER TAKEAWAY

What This Project Demonstrates

This project demonstrates mobile UX design, visual design judgment, Figma systems thinking, component architecture, and the ability to refine academic work into a portfolio-grade product artifact.

Mobile UX Design

Visual Design

Design Systems

Component Architecture

Figma Expertise

Award-Recognized Work